guessed he would be.[8]

General Jeong Jung-bu, as it happened, was related by marriage to two of the banished friends of Prince Kyong; two of the younger officers under his personal command, Senior Captains Yi Ko and Yi Uibang, were from the same clan as another of the exiles. After the raucous dinner party of 1167, unhappiness over Uijong's high-handedness, simmering along in an unfocused diffusion beneath the surface, began to coalesce into a solid core of resentment around these three.

Three years later, the resentment erupted.

Civilian and military officials had gathered for a memorial service, during which the gap between them grew painfully clear: "Now the civilian officials are haughty, drunk, and full," one of Jeong Jung-bu's officers complained to him, "but the military officials are hungry and troubled. How long can we endure this?" Jeong Jung-bu, still smarting over Kim Ton-jung's insult, agreed. "And thus," the *Goryeosa* concludes, "they began to plot a coup."[9]

Their opportunity came quickly. The next day, the king staged a boxing competition, offering generous prizes for the winner. During one of the matches, a civilian official named Han Roe mocked the losing officer, finally pushing him down on the ground to demonstrate his weakness. "The king and his officials applauded and laughed heartily," the *Goryeosa* explains.

This was the match that lit a very short fuse. At twilight on that same day, Jeong Jung-bu led his co-conspirators in an attack on the palace gates. The guards, surprised, were no match for the rebels, who poured into the palace shouting, "Death to all who wear the civil official headdress!" and massacring the civilian officials. Han Roe hid under the king's bed but was dragged out and knifed to death outside the king's quarters. In the bloodbath, Kim Ton-jung also died.[10]

When it was over, an entire layer of Goryeo's government had been wiped out: "Their corpses were piled as high as a mountain," the *Goryeosa* says. Uijong survived by handing over all power to Jeong Jung-bu and his fellow officers, who spared his life but exiled him to isolated Koje Island, off the southern coast. In his place, the conspirators crowned his younger brother Myeongjong. Nearly forty, weak and accommodating, Myeongjong would sit on the Goryeo throne for twenty-seven years, wielding no power whatsoever.[11]

Through disregarding its soldiers, pushing them down and away, Goryeo had fallen under a military rule that would last nearly a century.

It was not a peaceful regime. For one thing, General Jeong Jung-bu had rivals. His younger allies, Yi Ko and Yi Uibang, helped him to form the